

Recipe Change Approval Procedure

Food Safety · 2024-01 · Revision 3

1. Purpose

This procedure states how a change to a recipe is classified and what level of approval it needs before it is put into use. It applies to every product the company makes.

A change that has not been approved at the level this procedure requires shall not be used in production.

The procedure names approval levels. It does not name the people who hold them. The role that holds each level is stated in the approval matrix in force on the date the change is raised.

2. Change classes

Every recipe change is placed in one class when it is raised. The class is recorded on the recipe change.

Class	What it covers
Class A	A change to an ingredient
Class B	A change to a quantity or to a supplier pack size
Class C	A change to the process or to packaging
Class D	A documentation-only change, such as a correction to wording

Where a change falls into more than one class, the class nearest the top of the table applies.

3. Approval level by class

Class	Approval level
Class A	Level 3
Class B	Level 2
Class C	Level 2
Class D	Level 1

A documentation-only change is Class D and needs Level 1 approval.

A change shall be approved at the level shown, or at a higher level. Approval at a lower level is not valid.

4. Allergen-critical recipes

This section applies only to recipes marked allergen-critical on the recipe card, and to no other recipe.

A recipe carries the mark when it is made on a line shared with a product containing nuts, sesame, milk or egg, or when one of its ingredients is milled or packed on such a line. The mark is set by Food Safety when the recipe card is first issued and is reviewed whenever the line plan changes.

For these recipes a small change can matter more than it appears to. A change of wording on a label can remove a warning a customer relies on. A change of pack size can bring in stock from a different packing line. A change of process can move the product onto a different table or into a different oven. None of these would need more than a routine check for an ordinary recipe.

The recipe card shows the mark in the top right corner. A baker who is unsure whether a recipe carries the mark shall ask the shift supervisor before any change is used.

Level 3 approval is required for every change to such a recipe, whatever its class. This includes a documentation-only change.

5. Records

The recipe change is the record of the change. It states the class and the procedure revision in force. It does not state the approval level and it does not name the approver.